Certification and Compliance Tracker

Product working name: CertiKeep
Initial market: Small and medium-sized construction firms

1. Problem statement

Small construction companies need to know whether every worker's safety training, first-aid certificate, forklift licence and other required credentials are still valid. In many small teams, the information sits in a spreadsheet, email attachments, paper folders or someone's memory. Someone has to check dates, chase workers for missing documents and arrange refresher training. Because certificates expire throughout the year, this is a recurring job rather than a once-a-year task. A missed expiry can keep a worker off a site, delay a job or create problems during an inspection.

2. Users and customers

Market size. We start with construction firms in Luxembourg that have at least 10 employees. Our interviews suggest that very small firms do not feel the problem yet: a one-person business owner told us spreadsheets would be enough for years, while a 36-employee company spends about 10 minutes every day checking certificates and sending reminders by hand.

Step	Number	Source
Active construction enterprises in Luxembourg (NACE F)	4,496	STATEC, Lustat D1300
Share with more than 10 employees	≈ 24%	Luxinnovation (75.6% have 1–10 employees)
Serviceable market: construction firms with 10+ employees	**≈ 1,100**	4,496 × 24%
Target: 5% within three years	**≈ 55 firms**	our assumption

Firms of this size have enough workers and certificates that manual tracking becomes a recurring cost, but usually no dedicated HR or HSE software. Once we have customers in Luxembourg, the next step is the Greater Region (Lorraine, Saarland, Rhineland-Palatinate, Wallonia), where many construction firms work across the same borders.

3. Interviews

#	Company type	Size	Interviewee role	How we reached them	Format	Date	Interviewer(s)
A	[sector], Luxembourg	36 employees	HR	Family connection of	Phone, ~10	[date]	Sacha

#	Company type	Size	Interviewee role	How we reached them	Format	Date	Interviewer(s)
				a team member	min		
B	[sector], Luxembourg	1 person (owner)	Owner	Prior acquaintance; first contacted via Discord	Phone, ~15 min	[date]	Luc, Sacha

Names and contact details are kept in a private team file and can be shown on request.

Interview A: HR, 36-person company

- Tracks employees, certificates and expiry dates in an Excel sheet.
- Main pain: expiries are checked by hand and reminders are sent by hand.
- No missed work so far because of expired certificates, but some last-minute stress and extra work to get renewals done in time.
- Spends about 10 minutes a day checking certificates for 36 employees (~3.5 h/month).
- Most wanted features: automatic reminder emails and one central platform.
- Current cost: only the Office 365 subscription they already pay for.

Interview B: owner, one-person business

- No employees yet; expects 2–3 within 3–5 years and more paperwork as the company grows.
- Has no system for certifications; would give the task to an employee later.
- Thinks spreadsheets are enough until roughly 100 employees; sees no benefit from CertiKeep at his current size.
- No preference between a custom build and a subscription; would decide on architecture, UI and ease of use. Expects a custom solution to cost from about €30,000.

What we learned

- The pain is real at 36 employees: manual checks, manual reminders, last-minute renewals.
- Micro-businesses don't feel it. Our segment should be firms with 10+ employees.
- Their current tooling costs almost nothing (Excel/Office 365), so pricing has to be low and saved time has to be obvious.
- Gap: neither interviewee is a construction firm. Next interviews: [planned construction contacts].

4. Existing alternatives

- **Excel and calendar reminders:** cheap and familiar, but someone still has to enter dates, chase missing files and keep records up to date.
- **Full HR/HSE compliance software:** may offer more controls, but can be expensive or too complex for a small firm that just needs reliable certificate tracking.

- **Paper folders or doing nothing until an audit:** requires last-minute searching and can leave managers discovering expired or missing documents when they are needed most.

5. Value proposition

For site and operations managers at small construction firms who need to keep workers qualified without chasing paperwork, CertiKeep is an AI-assisted certification tracker that flags expiries early, organises renewals and keeps audit-ready records, unlike spreadsheets and calendar reminders.

6. Why AI

Certificates arrive as scans, phone photos and PDFs in different layouts, so copying every name, certificate type and expiry date into a spreadsheet is slow and error-prone. AI-based document reading can extract the likely details and match them to a worker's record, while confidence checks send unclear cases to a person. It can also pre-fill renewal paperwork. A manager should still verify extracted dates and any role-specific legal requirements; AI should support compliance decisions, not make them unchecked.

Sources

- STATEC, *Le Luxembourg en chiffres 2024*, active enterprises by economic activity (Lustat D1300): https://statistiques.public.lu/dam-assets/catalogue-publications/luxembourg-en-chiffres/2024/luxembourg-en-chiffres-2024.pdf
- Luxinnovation, *Panorama of Luxembourg's construction ecosystem* (2025): https://luxinnovation.lu/resources/construction-ecosystem-facts-figures